

01 SMALL TALK

When did you last speak English to someone? Just one sentence is fine.

Do you like texting in English or talking face to face more?

What English word do you say a lot these days?

02 POP QUIZ — DOES THIS SOUND NATURAL?

1 ~~"I want to develop myself."~~

✓ "I want to grow professionally. / I want to develop my skills."

'develop myself'는 사진 현상처럼 어색하게 들려요. 사람의 성장은 grow나 develop my skills로 써요.

2 ~~"My company is very welfare."~~

✓ "My company has great benefits. / good perks."

welfare는 형용사가 아니에요. 회사 복지·혜택은 benefits나 perks라고 해요.

3 ~~"I resigned my job."~~

✓ "I quit my job. / I resigned."

resign은 목적어를 바로 못 받아요. 일상에선 그냥 quit my job이 자연스러워요.

03 오늘의 워업

각 질문에 A 또는 B 손가락으로 표시. 마음에 드는 거 하나만 짧게 이유.

WARM-UP

Quick Choice (5분)

1 When you don't understand a foreign friend, do you A) ask them to say it again, or B) just smile and nod?

2 To sound more natural in English, is it better to A) study more grammar, or B) learn more everyday phrases?

3 When you make a funny English mistake, do you A) feel embarrassed, or B) laugh about it?

4 To say no to a friend's plan, do you A) say 'no' directly, or B) give a soft excuse like 'maybe next time'?

CAREER · MAIN DISCUSSION

Konglish Moments — When Your English Confuses Foreign Friends?

BACKGROUND

한국어식 사고방식이 영어 표현으로 옮겨질 때는 자연스럽게 어색함이 생길 수 있어요. 한국에서는 자연스럽게 쓰는 말도 영어로 그대로 옮기면 원어민에게 딱딱하거나, 너무 직접적이거나, 전혀 다른 의미로 들릴 수 있어요. Konglish의 핵심은 틀렸다는 느낌보다 '의도는 알겠는데 자연스럽지는 않은' 지점이에요. 특히 부탁, 거절, 칭찬, 약속 변경처럼 관계가 섞인 말일수록 단어보다 톤과 상황이 더 중요해요. 그래서 원어민과 이야기할 때는 문법보다 자연스러운 표현과 뉘앙스를 같이 고치는 게 도움이 돼요.

READ BEFORE WE TALK

Konglish moments often happen when a Korean expression is translated too directly into English. The grammar may not be wrong, but the sentence can sound stiff, too strong, too vague, or simply not like something a native speaker would say. The tricky part is that the speaker's meaning is usually clear in Korean. Problems appear when tone, politeness, or indirect meaning does not transfer well. Requests, refusals, compliments, and schedule changes are especially sensitive, because they are not only about vocabulary. They are about how the sentence feels to the listener. That is why natural feedback from native speakers can be more useful than only checking grammar.

WORDS YOU MIGHT NEED

on the spot — 갑자기 그 자리에서

freeze up — 얼어붙다, 말이 막히다

let it flow — 흐름에 맡기다

look it up — (단어를) 찾아보다

read the room — 분위기를 읽다

come off too blunt — 너무 무뎡뎡하게 들리다

TRY THESE PHRASES

Honestly, I do build it in Korean first, and then ____.

Most of the time, when I translate word by word, ____.

Out of those four, ____ is the hardest for me because ____.

I'd say ____ trips me up the most, since in Korean ____.

EASY ENTRY

- 1 Quick — if you had to pick one Konglish word you use the most: 'fighting,' 'service,' or 'eye-shopping'?
- 2 When was the last time a foreign friend looked confused by your English? What did you say?
- 3 On a scale of 1 to 5, how much do you worry about Konglish slipping out when you speak English with a foreigner?
- 4 What's your usual move when you don't know the natural English word — guess, gesture, or grab your phone?

MAIN DISCUSSION

Q1. Do you build the sentence in Korean first, then change it to English? What happens when you do?

↳ Honestly, I do build it in Korean first, and then ____.

↳ Most of the time, when I translate word by word, ____.

Q2. Which is hardest for you in English: asking, refusing, complimenting, or changing plans? Why?

↳ Out of those four, ____ is the hardest for me because ____.

↳ I'd say ____ trips me up the most, since in Korean ____.

Q3. If a native speaker corrected your English right away, would you feel grateful or embarrassed?

↳ I'd feel grateful, to be honest, because ____.

↳ It depends on the moment, but usually I'd feel ____.

Q4. What's the difference between Konglish that sounds cute and Konglish that causes a misunderstanding?

↳ The way I see it, cute Konglish ____, while the risky kind ____.

↳ The main difference comes down to ____.

Q5. What matters most for natural English: vocabulary, grammar, tone, or reading the situation?

↳ I lean more toward ____ because ____.

↳ When I think about it, ____ matters most, since ____.